

FRIDAY EVENING: TONE VI AT VESPERS

On “Lord, I have cried ...,” 3 Stichera of the righteous ones, in Tone VI:

Spec. Mel.: “Having set aside ...”:

Verse: If Thou shouldest mark iniquities, O Lord, O Lord, who shall stand? * For with Thee there is forgiveness.

Walking in the footsteps of the sufferings of Christ, the whole company of the martyrs mightily went forth to many struggles. They confessed Him as God before ungodly tyrants and iniquitous kings, and endured many tortures, in the hope of receiving heavenly honors. These they now behold, rejoicing, and standing before the Lord with the choirs of all the incorporeal hosts.

Verse: For Thy name’s sake have I patiently waited for Thee, O Lord; my soul hath waited patiently for Thy word, * my soul hath hoped in the Lord.

O all-sacred shepherds, ye were emulators of the Christ, the Chief Shepherd, and preserved utterly unharmed the divinely chosen flock, the divine treasures of piety, driving away the wild wolves, and bringing them into the fold of heaven. As ye make your abode there, remember those who praise you with love, and pray ye with boldness unto Christ on behalf of our souls.

Verse: From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch * let Israel hope in the Lord.

O all ye venerable fathers, who living in holiness, vanquished the demons; and extinguishing the torments of conscience, valiantly endured the burning of the passions, O blessed ones, and ye rejoice now with the heavenly hosts of incorporeal beings; for in the flesh ye emulated their life. With them entreat Christ, the supremely good God, that we who honor you may find deliverance from our falls.

Then the Stichera from the Menaion; or if there is no Menaion, these Stichera of the holy martyrs, in the same melody:

Verse: For with the Lord there is mercy, and with Him there is plenteous redemption; * and He shall redeem Israel out of all his iniquities.

Thy martyrs, O Lord, denied Thee not, nor did they forsake Thy commandments; by their intercessions have mercy upon us.

Verse: O praise the Lord, all ye nations; * praise Him, all ye peoples.

Repeat: Thy martyrs, O Lord ...,

Verse: For He hath made His mercy to prevail over us, * and the truth of the Lord abideth forever.

O martyred passion-bearers, citizens of heaven, who suffered on the earth, ye endured many torments. By their prayers and intercessions, O Lord, preserve us all.

Glory ..., Both now ..., Dogmatic Theotokion:

Who doth not call thee blessed, O most holy Virgin? * Who will not hymn thy most pure birthgiving? * For the only-begotten Son Who hath shone forth timelessly from the Father, * came forth, ineffably incarnate, from thee, O pure one; * By nature He is God, by nature for our sakes, He hath become a man * not divided into two Hypostases, * but known in two natures without commingling. * Him do thou beseech, O pure and most blessed one, ** that our souls find mercy!

Then, “O Joyous Light ...,” the Prokeimenon, in Tone VII:

Prokeimenon: O God, my helper art Thou, * and Thy mercy shall go before me.

Verse: Rescue me from mine enemies, O God, and from them that rise up against me redeem me.

Vouchsafe, O Lord ..., Litany: Let us complete ..., Then:

On the Aposticha, these Stichera, in Tone VI:

To the martyrs: Those who suffered martyrdom for Thee, O Christ, endured a multitude of torments, and have received perfect crowns in the heavens, may they ever intercede on behalf of our souls.

Verse: Blessed are they whom Thou hast chosen * and taken to Thyself, O Lord.

To the martyrs: Thy Cross O Lord, was the invincible weapon of the martyrs. They beheld impending death before them; but, foreseeing the life that is to come, they became strengthened with hope in Thee. By their intercessions have mercy on us.

Verse: Their souls * shall dwell among good things.

For the reposed: Thy command was to me my beginning and foundation. For desiring to fashion me into a living creature from natures visible and invisible: Thou didst form my body from the earth, and given me a soul by Thy divine and quickening breath. Wherefore, O Christ, grant rest to Thy servants in the land of the living, in the habitations of the righteous.

Glory ..., Both now ..., Theotokion:

By the prayers of her that gaveth birth to Thee O Christ,* and of Thy martyrs and apostles, * the prophets and holy hierarchs, * the venerable, the righteous and of all the saints, ** grant rest to Thy departed servants.

Then, “Now lettest Thou Thy servant depart ...,” Trisagion through Our Father ..., Troparia. Litany: Have mercy on us ..., and Dismissal.

FRIDAY NIGHT: TONE VI

AT COMPLINE

Canon of supplication to the most holy Theotokos

ODE I

Irmos: **A** helper and a protector * hath become unto me salvation. * My God, whom I will glorify, * the God of my fathers, * and I will exalt Him * for gloriously hath He been glorified.

Reject me not, O good one, neither abominate nor despise me who with fervor hasten beneath thy tender compassion, O pure one, but grant that I may share in the grace which resides in thee.

O good Theotokos, helper of the sorrowful, accept the sighing which issueth forth from my soul, and deliver me from all the shameless evils I have grievously committed.

Glory ..., **B**efore thee do I fall down, O good one, thou intercessor for the troubled. From everlasting fire, from darkness and the abyss deliver me who have lived my whole life in evil.

Both now ..., **W**oe is me! How can I who have immeasurably sinned before entreat Thee, O my Jesus? Yet I offer Thee as a mediatrix the pure one who gave birth to Thee. Have mercy and save me!

ODE III

Irmos: **O** Lord, upon the rock * of Thy commandments * make firm my heart, * for Thou alone art Holy and Lord.

I fall down before thee, O Mother of the Word. In thy compassion accept me, and by thy fervent prayers grant forgiveness of sins unto me who beseech thee.

Have mercy upon me, O Lady, have mercy upon me, and deliver me from all wickedness, from the oppression of the demons and everlasting torment.

Glory ..., **R**estrain me who am smitten with the bitterness of lusts, O Lady, granting me the divine sobriety of repentance and saving conversion.

Both now ..., **O** Birthgiver of God, who ineffably gave birth to the Lord and Creator of all things, entreat Him to save thy flock.

ODE IV

Irmos: **T**he prophet heard * of Thy coming, O Lord, * and he was afraid. * How wast Thou to be born of a virgin * and appear unto mankind? * and he said * “I have heard report of Thee and I am afraid”; * glory to Thy power, O Lord.

Constantly picking at the sores brought upon my soul by the love of sensuality, and in pain from the stripes they cause me, I lie lacking feeling and unhealed. O Birthgiver of God, have mercy and heal me, and save me By thy prayers.

The darkness of sin hath covered my soul, O Birthgiver of God, such that I go about in the light as though it were night, not knowing the commandments of Christ. O thou who hast given birth to the divine Light, have mercy upon me and enlighten me, I pray.

Glory ..., **T**he Word of the living God descended into thy womb, O Virgin Mother and, receiving my substance through thy most pure blood, He came forth in two natures, but a single hypostasis. Him do thou beseech, that He save our souls.

Both now ..., **I** have assiduously gone through the desires of the body and all pleasures, and have thereby become wholly corrupt, vile and abominable. O most pure Birthgiver of God, have mercy, and save me in thy tender compassion.

ODE V

Irmos: **O**ut of the night I seek Thee early, * enlighten me I pray Thee, O Lover of mankind, * and guide me in Thy commandments, * and teach me, O Savior, * to do Thy will.

I have kindled for myself the fire of Gehenna, doing that which is shameful, and have grievously brought upon myself the wrath of God. Help me, O pure one, and forsake me not.

Though I am ever asking for the remission of my transgressions, yet I never cease committing exceedingly wicked deeds, O most pure one, and I offend thee. O purification of the faithful, have pity on me!

Glory ..., **O** pure one, entreat Jesus, to Whom thou hast given birth through thy blood - perfect man and true God - that we be delivered from everlasting fire.

Both now ..., **O** impassable gate, open unto me the portals of true repentance, I pray, and show me the path of penitence, O pure one, thou guide of all.

ODE VI

Irmos: **W**ith my whole heart, I cried * unto the tenderly compassionate God, * and he heard me * from the lowest depths of Hades; * and raised my life up from corruption.

Waves of shameful thoughts now engulf me; yet do thou guide me to the calm harbor of true repentance by thy tender compassion, O Lady.

Having acquired thee as our hope and unassailable rampart, our steadfast intercessor, O maiden, we are delivered from transgressions and grievous passions, and from all harm.

Glory ..., O pure Virgin Theotokos, I fall down before thee and cry out in lamentation: Deliver my wretched soul from the judgment which is to come, and from everlasting fire.

Both now ..., In thy supplications thou art the strength of those who are faint of soul, O most pure one; wherefore, disdain me not, but heal me who am sick of soul.

Lord, have mercy, (Thrice).

Glory ..., Both now ..., Sessional Hymn, in Tone VI:

In the loving-kindness of Thy compassions Thou didst come down to earth, O Christ, and became incarnate from the Virgin, sanctifying all on earth and calling them to heaven; wherefore, trusting in Thee, we no longer sin, but are freed from cares by Thee: for Thou art our Savior, Creator and God.

ODE VII

Irmos: We have sinned, we have transgressed, * and we have done evil before Thee. * We have not kept nor followed * Thy commandments, but reject us not utterly, * O God of our fathers.

When mine accursed soul will have to endure separation from my body, there will be no one to deliver or comfort it; do thou then stand forth, O Lady, and deliver me from the oppression of the demons.

I fall down before thee and offer thee fervent tears. I know thy love for mankind, I know thy long-suffering and guilelessness: have mercy upon me now, O pure one; forgive me and save me.

Glory ..., O Virgin, have mercy on my wretched soul which is beset by the passions. Look upon the tumult of my passions, look upon the inconstant burning of my flesh, and grant me thy saving help and salvation.

Both now ..., The Son and Word, Who is consubstantial and co-beginningless with the Father, received from thee flesh like thine, though immutably noetic and animate in a way He Himself knoweth; and therein He hath refashioned our nature into something higher, O pure Virgin,

ODE VIII

Irmos: Him whom the hosts of heaven glorify, * and before whom tremble the cherubim and seraphim, * let every breath and all creation * praise, bless, and supremely exalt, * throughout all ages.

I am at a loss when I consider my acts, and I tremble before the dread tribunal of the Judge. What answer shall I give at that time, wretch that I am? O Sovereign Lady of the world, be thou my helper.

Turn not thy face away from me, O Lady, when I gaze upon thine image, but be merciful unto me, and avert from me the sentence which will be pronounced.

Glory ..., O Mary, thou unwedded Bride of God, deliver me thy servant, from all the harm of the wicked one, I cry to thee, and at the coming trial stand before me as an advocate, O thou who alone art the intercessor for Christians.

Both now ..., That He might deify mankind, O Lady, thy Son revealed Himself to be a perfect man through thee; wherefore, beseech Him, that He show me forth as wholly purified, and a partaker in His divine kingdom.

ODE IX

Irmos: O Virgin who received the angel's salutation * and hast given birth to thine own Creator, * save those who magnify thee.

Thou alone art the intercessor for all mankind, O most pure one; thou art the bulwark of Christians, O pure one. Thee do I now set before Christ as a mediator for me, the lowly one, that By thy prayers He may have mercy on me, wretched as I am.

I have committed deeds of the night, and the night of tortures should rightly now cover me, the vain one, and the retribution of hell should receive me; but as thou hast given birth to God the Judge, O pure Virgin, deliver me from all torment.

Glory ..., I have wasted the time of my life in evils, I have drawn nigh unto the gates of Hades, but in nowise desire to enter therein. Help me, O good Theotokos, for I have placed my hope in thee.

Both now ..., O right loving Lady, adornment of the angels and glory of the martyrs, with them pray that we find mercy and remission of our debts, and help us all to finish well the race of our life in the doing of good.

Then, "It is truly meet ...," and a prostration. Trisagion through Our Father ..., Troparion, and the rest as usual. Dismissal.

ON SATURDAY MORNING: TONE VI
AT MATINS

After the 1st chanting of the Psalter,
The Sessional Hymns of the holy martyrs, in Tone VI:

Ever enlightened by Thee, and having extinguished the lamp of the infidels, like lamps the saints always shine forth light upon the righteous. By their prayers, O our Savior, light Thou my lamp, and save me, O Lord.

Verse: Wondrous is God in His saints, * the God of Israel.

Having patiently endured the struggle of martyrdom, the saints received from Thee the honors of victory; having set at naught the intentions of the iniquitous, they received crowns of incorruption. For their sake be Thou entreated, O God, and grant us great mercy.

Glory ..., Both now ..., Theotokion:

O Thou Who called Thy Mother blessed, Thou didst willingly go to Thy suffering, and shine forth upon the Cross, desiring to seek out Adam, and saying to the angels: Rejoice with Me, for I have found the lost coin! O our God Who hast wisely ordered all things, glory be to Thee!

After the 2nd chanting of the Psalter,
The Sessional Hymns of the holy martyrs, in Tone VI:

To the martyrs: While the choirs of the incorporeal ones stood by, holding trophies of victory, and tyrants and kings were amazed, the most wise spiritual athletes showed forth a firm opposition amidst the wounds of torture, during their martyrdom at the tribunal, thereby casting down the apostate by their confession of Christ. O Lord Who strengthened them, glory be to Thee!

Verse: Wondrous is God in His saints, * the God of Israel.

To the martyrs: The memorial of Thy saints, O Lord, hath appeared like the the garden of paradise in Eden, for therein all creation rejoiceth. By their prayers grant us peace and great mercy.

Verse: Many are the tribulations of the righteous, * and the Lord shall deliver them out of them all.

For the reposed: Truly all things are vanity; life is but a shadow and a dream: for in vain doth every mortal trouble himself, as the Scripture hath said, seeking to acquire the whole world, and then departing to the tomb, where kings and paupers are found together. Wherefore, O Christ God, grant rest to Thy departed servants in that Thou lovest mankind.

Glory ..., Both now ..., Theotokion:

I offer thee sighs from the heart and my innermost being, and I pray for thy conciliatory help, O all-immaculate one, as saith the Scriptures. Have mercy on my passion-plagued soul, and entreat the greatly merciful God, that He deliver me from judgment and the lake of fire, O only blessed one.

ODE I

Canon of the holy martyrs, hierarchs, the venerable, and the departed, the composition of Joseph, in Tone VI:

Irmos: The lecherous Pharaoh was drowned with all his warriors, * and Israel, crossing through the midst of the sea, * cried aloud exclaiming: * Let us chant unto the Lord God, * for He hath been glorified!

Having enlightened those in darkness with your radiant intelligence and put to shame the impious tyrants, O martyrs, ye manifestly became victors, and have passed over to the never-waning Light.

Resplendent in the beauties of the virtues, O holy hierarchs of Christ, ye choirs of the venerable, O only triumphal procession of the prophets and all the righteous, ye have entered the mansions of heaven.

All the multitude of women who joined themselves unto Christ have with manly labors trampled underfoot him who by a grievous deception brought death upon Eve; wherefore they are blessed with divine hymns.

Glory ..., For the reposed: **O** Christ Who in the beginning formed man out of the earth, in the habitations of the righteous, in places of ease, grant rest to the souls of Thy servants, we pray, in that Thou art supremely good.

Both now ..., **T**hou hast been shown to be more sacred than the cherubim and the seraphim, O pure one who hast given birth to the Author of creation. Him do thou unceasingly entreat, that He have pity on thy servants, who glorify thee.

Another canon, of the departed, the composition of Theophanes, in Tone VI:

Irmos: When Israel walked on foot in the sea as on dry land, * on seeing their pursuer Pharaoh drowned, * they cried: * Let us sing to God * a song of victory.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

In the chambers of heaven the valiant martyrs always beseech Thee, O Christ. Grant that the faithful whom Thou hast translated from the earth may receive everlasting good things.

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

O Thou Who hast adorned all things, Thou didst form man's living substance midway between lowliness and majesty; wherefore, grant rest to the souls of Thy servants, O Savior.

Glory ..., **I**n the beginning Thou didst set me to be a dweller and husbandman in the garden of paradise; yet Thou didst eject me, who broke Thy commandment; but grant rest to the souls of Thy servants, O Savior.

Both now ..., **H**e Who of old fashioned our first mother Eve from Adam's rib is clothed in flesh through thy most pure womb; and therewith He hath destroyed the might of death, O pure one.

ODE III.

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: **H**aving established my thoughts upon the firm rock of Thy Faith, * make steadfast my soul, O Lord; * for I have Thee as my refuge * and confirmation, * O good One.

Subjected to bodily pangs, the spiritual athletes looked forward, rejoicing, to a painless reward; and they now dispel our many pangs with grace.

Driving away the beasts of evil with steadfast mind, the divine hierarchs delivered the godly children of Christ unharmed by their malice.

Having mortified carnal-mindedness, the choir of the venerable, willingly bowing under the yoke of the Lord, received life everlasting.

Glory ..., **For the reposed:** **F**rom everlasting fire, O Christ, deliver those who have passed from this life in piety, and grant them remission of debts and eternal delight, O good One.

Both now ..., **T**he women who loved Christ, surrounding thee who ineffably gave birth unto Him, O all-holy Lady, rejoice and are glad with a joyous mind.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: **T**here is none as holy as Thou, * O Lord my God, * who hast exalted the horn of Thy faithful O good One, * and strengthened us upon the rock * of Thy confession.

Refrain: **W**ondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Having suffered lawfully and been adorned by Thee with crowns of victory, Thy martyrs, O Bestower of life, earnestly ask that everlasting honor be given unto the faithful who have passed away.

Refrain: **G**rant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

Having first with many miracles and signs instructed me, the lost one, in latter times Thou didst abase Thyself as One compassionate; and having searched, Thou didst find and save me.

Glory ..., They who come to Thee from the one who poureth forth unstable corruption do Thou cause to dwell joyously in the eternal mansions, O good One, justifying them by faith and grace.

Both now ..., There is none as immaculate as thee, O most pure Mother of God; for thou alone didst conceive in thy womb the true God Who is from before the ages, and hath destroyed the power of death.

ODE IV

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: O Lord, I have heard the report of Thee * and was afraid; * I have seen Thy works and was amazed. * Glory to Thy power, O Lord.

Standing fast, the passion-bearers beheld the prideful one trampled under their feet; and in thanksgiving they glorified the Creator of all things.

Armed with the splendors of words, the holy hierarchs save all from the darkness of heresies, leading them to the light of understanding.

The venerable ones, consuming the material passions with an ardent understanding of God, were revealed to be burning coals, and are greatly glorified.

Glory ..., **For the reposed: O Lord** Who hast dominion over the living and the dead, unto those whom Thou hast taken to Thyself grant rest with all who have been well-pleasing unto Thee.

Both now ..., **O** most pure one, the Lord Who ineffably clothed Himself in flesh from thee hath taken to Himself the company of women who struggled manfully .

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: Christ is my power, * my God and my Lord, * the holy Church divinely singeth, * crying with a pure mind, * keeping festival in the Lord.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Revealing knowledge greater than wisdom and the most perfect goodness of spiritual gifts, O Master, Thou didst unite the choirs of the martyrs to the angels.

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

Grant that those who have passed over to Thee may receive Thy most pure glory, O Christ, wherein are the dwelling-places of those who are glad and the voices of pure rejoicing.

Glory ..., **T**hose who hymn Thy divine might do Thou receive, taking them from this earth and making them children of the Light, and cleansing them of the darkness of sin, O greatly Merciful One.

Both now ..., **T**he Master chose thee as the most pure receptacle, the immaculate temple, the most holy ark, the virginal place of sanctity, the beauty of Jacob.

ODE V

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: O Christ Who shineth Thy light upon the world, * illumine my heart * for I cry out to Thee in the night, * and save me.

Clothing yourselves in vesture woven of grace from on high, O spiritual athletes, ye stripped the enemy naked.

We honor the holy prophets, the divinely wise hierarchs, and the venerable who were well-pleasing unto God.

In psalms and hymns let us praise the company of women, for they were well pleasing unto God.

Glory ..., **For the reposed: E**nroll Thy servants in the mansions of Thy righteous ones, O Lord, overlooking the offenses they committed in this life.

Both now ..., **T**hou wast revealed to be she who hath delivered us from all the harm of the enemy, O Lady, entreating Christ, Who alone is compassionate.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: Illumine with Thy divine light, I pray, O good One, * the souls of those who with love rise early to pray to Thee, * that they may know Thee, O Word of God, * as the true God, * Who recalleth us from the darkness of sin.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Sacrificing themselves to our glorious God as a sacred whole-burnt offering and the first-fruits of human nature, the martyrs ever win salvation for us.

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

Grant a sojourn in heaven and generous gifts unto Thy faithful servants who have fallen asleep, O Lord, granting them deliverance from transgressions.

Glory ..., **O** only Compassionate and Immortal One, Who alone art by nature the Bestower of life and the truly unfathomable Abyss of goodness: Grant Thy kingdom unto those who have fallen asleep.

Both now ..., **O** Sovereign Lady of the world, He Who was born from thee became the might, song and salvation of those who perished, delivering from the gates of Hades those who bless thee with faith.

ODE VI

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: Slain by the sea-monster of sin, * I cry unto Thee, O Christ: * Free me from corruption, * as Thou didst the prophet.

Ye engulfed the noetic foe with the outpouring of your divine blood; and ye watered the hearts of the faithful, O passion-bearers.

Having crucified yourselves to the world and the passions, O venerable ones, and ye holy hierarchs, ye have been deemed worthy of divine glory.

As is meet, we bless the choir of the prophets and the assembly of honorable women, who contended well.

Glory ..., **For the reposed: With** Thine elect give rest to the souls who have fallen asleep in times past, O God, overlooking their transgressions.

Both now ..., **O** thou who hast given birth to Christ in the flesh, slay the passions of my flesh, O Virgin, and give life to my soul by thy mediation.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: Beholding the sea of life surging with the tempest of temptations, * I run to Thy calm haven, and cry to Thee: * Raise up my life from corruption, * O greatly merciful One.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Nailed to the Cross, Thou didst gather to Thee the choirs of the martyrs who emulated Thy suffering, O good One; wherefore, we beseech Thee: Grant rest unto those who have passed over to Thee.

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

When in awesome manner and with ineffable glory Thou shalt come to judge the whole world, O Redeemer, be Thou well-pleased that thy faithful servants, whom Thou hast taken from the earth, may meet Thee in splendor on the clouds.

Glory ..., **O** Master, Who art the wellspring of life, make Thy servants to dwell amid the nourishment of paradise, for with divine courage they have departed unto Thee in faith; and do Thou lead up those who were bound chains. .

Both now ..., **H**aving broken the commandment of God, we returned to the earth; but because of thee, O Virgin, we have been elevated from earth to the heavens, shaking off the corruption of death.

ODE VII

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: Harkening to the hymnody of Thy venerable children * Thou didst bedew the burning furnace: * O Lord God of our fathers blessed art Thou!

Let us honor with hymns the passion-bearers of Christ, who quenched the flame of cruel ungodliness with the showers of their blood.

Having destroyed the winter of heresies, the right glorious hierarchs proceeded, rejoicing, to the springtime of God.

By patience the ascetics inherited the rich grace of the Spirit and destroyed a multitude of demons.

Glory ..., For the reposed: Grant, O Compassionate and greatly Merciful One, that those who have passed from this life may inherit the paradise of Thy sustenance.

Both now ..., He Who showed thee to be a virgin even after giving birth, O pure one, saved the choirs of holy women who followed thee.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: An angel made the furnace bedew the holy Children, * but the command of God consumed the Chaldeans * and prevailed upon the tyrant to cry: * “O God of our fathers, blessed art Thou.”

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Delivered from the first crime by Thy blood, the martyrs, stained with their own blood, manifestly prefigured Thy sacrifice. Blessed art Thou, O God of our fathers!

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

Thou didst slay savage death, O life-creating Word. Accept those who have departed in faith, and who hymn Thee, O Christ, and say: O God of our fathers Blessed art Thou!

Glory ..., O most divine Master, Who breathed Thy divine breath into me, and grant Thy kingdom unto those who have passed from this life, O Savior, that they may hymn Thee and say: O God of our fathers Blessed art Thou!

Both now ..., Thou wast the most exalted of all created beings, O most immaculate one, having conceived Him Who broke down the gates of Hades and shattered its doors; wherefore, we, the faithful, hymn thee as the Mother of God.

ODE VIII

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: **Thy venerable Children in the furnace * likened to the cherubim * chanted the thrice-holy hymn * Bless ye, praise ye and supremely exalt ye the Lord throughout all ages.**

Wounded in their valor by threefold waves of torments, the divine martyrs, passing into profound peace by grace, attained unto the kingdom on high.

The venerable and all-wise hierarchs, shining like the sun, enlighten the whole world with the rays of their teachings and the splendors of healings.

O all ye glorious prophets and hierarchs, ye venerable and righteous ones, ye multitudes of martyrs and women: Preserve your whole flock unshaken by the demons.

Glory ..., For the reposed: **W**e hymn the righteous of ages past and the divinely eloquent prophets, and we cry out with compunction: By their prayers, O Word, grant rest unto those who have fallen asleep in faith.

Both now ..., **T**he choir of women loved thee as the full and nearby beauty of God, O Virgin, and in thine entourage they were brought before the Master of all, blessing thee together, O most pure one.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: **Thou didst make flame bedew the holy children, * and didst burn the sacrifice of a righteous man with water. * For Thou alone, O Christ, dost do all as Thou willest, * Thee do we supremely exalt throughout all ages.**

Refrain: **Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.**

Mightily showing forth struggles, ye received crowns of victory, O martyrs and passion-bearers, crying out to Christ: We supremely exalt Thee, the Lord, throughout the ages!

Refrain: **Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.**

The faithful, who in a sacred manner have forsaken the things of this life and have meekly gone to Thee, the Master, do Thou receive, in that Thou art full of tender compassion, granting peace unto those who supremely exalt Thee, the Lord, throughout the ages.

Glory ..., Be Thou well-pleased, O Savior, that all who have fallen asleep in the past may now dwell in the land of the meek, justifying by faith in Thee and by grace those who supremely exalt Thee, the Lord, throughout the ages.

Both now ..., We all call thee blessed, O exceedingly blessed one, for thou didst truly give birth to the good Word, Who became flesh for our sake. Him do we exalt supremely throughout all ages.

We then chant the hymn of the Theotokos (the Magnificat), with the refrain: “More honorable than the cherubim ...,” and make prostrations.

ODE IX

Canon of all the righteous

Irmos: O Virgin who received the angel’s salutation * and hast given birth to thine own Creator, * save those who magnify thee.

Ye were brought to the Master as pure sheep, O passion-bearing martyrs. Him do ye entreat, that He save our souls.

As shepherds ye tended the faithful in the fields of piety, O holy hierarchs, and now dwell in the fold of God.

Let us bless the choirs of the venerable with the holy hierarchs and prophets, and the women who suffered mightily.

Glory ..., For the reposed: O greatly Merciful One, grant that the departed may receive the eternal gladness of which the councils of the saints partake.

Both now ..., O Virgin who hast given birth to the Light, enlighten my soul, driving away the darkness of my slothfulness and sin.

Canon of the reposed

Irmos: It is impossible for mankind to see God * upon Whom the orders of angels dare not gaze; * but through thee, O all-pure one, * did the Word Incarnate become a man * and with the heavenly hosts, * Him we magnify and thee we call blessed.

Refrain: Wondrous is God in His saints, the God of Israel.

Hope strengthened the choirs of the martyrs, and enkindled thereby they took wing to the love of Thee, thereby depicting beforehand the truly unshakable rest which is to come, which do Thou grant unto the faithful departed, O good One.

Refrain: Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy departed servants.

Be Thou well-pleased, O Christ, that those who have departed in faith may receive Thy radiant and divine effulgence, granting them rest in the bosom of Abraham, and granting them everlasting blessedness, in that Thou alone art merciful.

Glory ..., As Thou art good and full of tender compassion by nature, the Willer of mercies and the Abyss of compassion, those of this place of affliction and the shadow of death hast Thou taken away. Cause them to dwell where Thy light shineth, O Savior.

Both now ..., O pure one, we know thee to be the holy tabernacle, the ark, the tablets, the law and grace; in that for thy sake remission hath been given to those who have been justified by the blood of Him Who became incarnate from thy womb, O all-immaculate one.

Then, “It is truly meet to bless thee ...,” and a prostration.

Small litany, Exapostilarion, and the usual psalms.

On the Praises, these Stichera of the holy martyrs, in Tone V:

Verse: Praise Him for His mighty acts, * praise Him according to the multitude of His greatness.

To the martyrs: **A**t the commemoration of Thy saints, O Lord, all creation celebrateth; the heavens rejoice with the angels, and the earth with all mankind keepeth festival. By their intercessions have mercy upon us.

Verse: Praise Him with the sound of trumpet, * praise Him with the psaltery and harp.

O Lord, if we had not had Thy saints as intercessors, and Thy goodness being merciful to us, how should we have dared, O Savior, to hymn Thee, Whom angels do unceasingly glorify? O Thou that knowest the hearts of men, spare our souls.

Verse: Praise Him with timbrel and dance, * praise Him with strings and flute.

The memorial of the martyrs is a joy to those who fear the Lord. For having suffered for Christ’s sake, they received from Him crowns of victory; and now they intercede with boldness on behalf of our souls.

Verse: Praise Him with tuneful cymbals, praise Him with cymbals of jubilation. * Let every breath praise the Lord.

Our God hath made wondrous His chosen saints. Rejoice and be glad, all ye His servants, for crowns and His kingdom have been prepared for you! We beseech you: Forget us not!

For the reposed: **O**f old, the eating of the tree in Eden sickened Adam when the serpent spewed forth its venom; for from this universal death hath arisen, devouring man. But the Master came, and cast down the serpent, granting us resurrection. Unto Him, therefore, let us now cry aloud: Have pity on those whom Thou hast taken to Thyself, O Savior, and, as Thou art the Lover of mankind, grant them rest with the saints.

Glory ..., Both now ...,

Theotokion: **W**e have come to know God Who was incarnate of thee, O Virgin Theotokos. Him do thou entreat that our souls be saved.

Small Doxology (Read), Litany: Let us complete ...,
On the Aposticha, these Stichera of the departed, in Tone VI:
Spec. Mel.: “Having set aside ...”:

O greatly merciful Master, Who hast unapproachable loving-kindness for us and an inexhaustible well-spring of divine goodness. Grant rest in the land of the living to those who have departed unto Thee, that they forever abide in Thy dwelling-place, which they so longed so for. For Thou, O Christ, hast shed Thy blood for all, and hast redeemed the world with Thy life.

Verse: Blessed are they whom Thou hast chosen * and taken to Thyself, O Lord.

Thou didst willingly endure a life-creating death; pouring forth life upon the faithful, and granting them eternal joy. Do Thou establish in this joy those who have fallen asleep in the hope of the Resurrection, and in Thy mercy forgive them all their offences, for Thou alone art sinless, Thou alone art good and the Lover of mankind, that Thy Name, O Christ, may be hymned by all, and that we may glorify Thy salvific love for mankind.

Verse: Their souls * shall dwell among good things.

Knowing Thee to be, in Thy divine power, the Lord of the living and Master of the dead, O Christ, we pray Thee: With Thy chosen ones, O Lover of mankind, grant rest unto Thy faithful servants who have departed unto Thee, our Benefactor, in a place of comfort, amid the splendors of the saints; for Thou art He Who willest mercy, and as God savest those whom Thou didst create according to Thine image, O only greatly Merciful One.

Glory ..., Both now ..., Theotokion:

Thou wast shown to be a receptacle of divine majesty, O most pure one, for thou didst contain God and gave birth unto Christ in two natures but a single Hypostasis, O Mother who knewest not wedlock. O pure one, entreat thine only-begotten and firstborn Child, Who preserved thee an unblemished virgin even though thou hast given birth, that He grant rest amid light and incorrupt blessedness unto those who have fallen asleep in the Faith.

Then, “It is good to give thanks ...,” Trisagion ..., Our Father ..., Troparia.
Litany: Have mercy on us ..., First Hour, and Dismissal.

**ON SATURDAY MORNING: TONE VI
AT THE LITURGY**

On the Beatitudes, these Troparia, in Tone VI:

Remember me, O God my Savior, when Thou shalt come in Thy kingdom, and save me, in that Thou alone lovest mankind.

Undaunted by fire, the sword, or the savage onslaught of wild beasts, O glorious passion-bearers, ye have been deemed worthy of life everlasting.

O Lover of mankind, and Who hast glorified the prophets and teachers, the venerable and the righteous, by their supplications save Thou our souls

For the reposed: **T**hose who in faith have departed from temporal things do Thou number with all the saints and righteous, O Word, that we may glorify Thee.

Glory ..., Triadicon: **W**e glorify the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, saying: O Holy Trinity, save Thou our souls!

Both now ..., Thou hast been revealed to be blessed among all generations; for in truth thou didst ineffably give birth to our blessed God, O most pure one.

On Saturday, the Prokeimenon, in Tone VIII:

Prokeimenon, in Tone VIII: Be glad in the Lord, and rejoice, * O ye righteous.

Verse: Blessed are they whose iniquities are forgiven, and whose sins are covered.

And for the Departed, in Tone VI:

Prokeimenon, in Tone VI: Their souls * shall dwell among good things.

Alleluia, in Tone IV: The righteous cried, and the Lord heard them, and delivered them out of all their tribulations.

Verse: Many are the tribulations of the righteous, but the Lord shall deliver them out of them all.

Verse: Blessed are they whom Thou hast chosen and taken to Thyself, O Lord. Their memorial is unto generation and generation.

Communion Verse: Rejoice in the Lord, O ye righteous; praise is meet for the upright.

Another, for the departed:

Communion Verse: Blessed are they whom Thou hast chosen and taken to Thyself, O Lord. Their memorial is unto generation and generation.